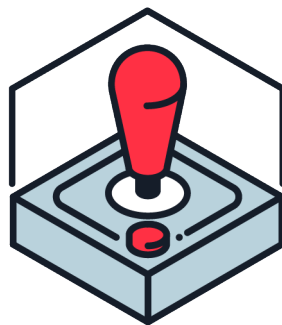




Video Game Metadata Schema: Controlled Vocabulary for **SETTING**

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Version History

2.2: June 2015

2.3: September 2024

2.3: December 2024, Formatting update: Updated reference structure for improved visual clarity and ease of use, with no changes to content. Table formatting was removed, and relationships between terms are now displayed hierarchically through indentation, with narrower terms shown as subsets of broader terms. Added "Built Environment" as a Broader Term (BT) for Castle, Hospital, Mine, Restaurant, and Vehicles. Added "Natural Environment" as a BT for Maze, Recreational Site, Religious Site, Rural Area, Underground, and Underwater. Changed "Wilderness" to "Surface" and added "Surface" as a BT for Volcano. Included relevant term relationships (SN, USE, USE FOR, BT, NT, RT) as appropriate.

Abbreviation Key

The following abbreviations are used throughout:

SN: Scope note

USE: Preferred term (See)

USE FOR: Equivalent term, lead-in term

BT: Broader term

NT: Narrower term

RT: Related term (See also)

Controlled Vocabulary for Setting

1. World

Used to specify the type of world the game takes place in. Choose one. If our world or alternate world is chosen, fill out Time Period and Place; it is not required for an imagined world.

Our world

SN: Game worlds created to represent reality.

Alternate world

SN: A fictional world with designs based in reality.

Imagined world

SN: A self-consistent fictional setting with elements that differ from reality.

2. Time Period

Prehistoric

SN: Features early technologies; stone tools and fire. Employs a mix of prehistoric creatures, dinosaurs, and cavemen.

Ancient

SN: Seen as the dawn of civilization with technologies containing Swords and Sandals. This time period is also known to be heavily steeped in mythology and god-lore.

Byzantine

SN: The Byzantine time period encompasses the Crusades, and is characterized by strong Roman and Greek influences.¹

Cold war

SN: The time period following the end of World War II (circa 1947-1991), in which tensions between the United States and the Soviet Union were high. It is characterized by a clash of political ideals between democracy and communism.

Dark ages

USE: **Medieval**

Medieval

SN: Castles are in abundance; the government style tends to focus on feudalism and in many cases there is a hereditary monarchy in place.

USE FOR: **Dark ages**

Reformation

SN: The time period marked by "religious, political, intellectual, and cultural upheaval" that split apart Catholic Europe during the 16th century. High profile individuals of this time include Martin Luther, John Calvin, and Henry VIII.²

¹ Byzantine Empire. (n.d.). In History. Retrieved from <http://www.history.com/topics/ancient-history/byzantine-empire>

² The Reformation. (n.d.). In History. Retrieved from <http://www.history.com/topics/reformation>

Renaissance

SN: Time period when gunpowder is first introduced; cultures are more focused on philosophy and the arts.

Imperial

SN: Pre World War I period of colonization, discovery, industrialization, and travel.

Modern

SN: A time of war and rebuilding of superpowers; World War II to the contemporary period. Technologies include cars, planes, and electronics.

Contemporary

SN: The part of history still in living memory.

Futuristic

SN: Focuses on interstellar exploration/colonization, interaction with alien species, and future empire building all while still having some relationship with Earth.

Western

SN: The time period characterized by cowboys, outlaws, and saloons.

Unspecified

SN: Not stated clearly or exactly.

Year (YYYY)

SN: In the style of the Gregorian calendar only if the specific year is present within the game. Also only used if Our World or Alternate World are selected.

3. Place

Natural Environment

SN: All living and nonliving things that are naturally on Earth.

NT: **Maze, Outer Space, Recreational Site, Religious Site, Rural Area, Sky, Surface, Underground, Underwater**

Maze

SN: A "confusing intricate network of passages."³

BT: **Natural Environment**

Nature Reserve

USE: **Surface**

Outer Space

SN: Void that exists between celestial bodies.

USE FOR: **Space, Mars**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Recreational site

SN: A place for recreational activities.

USE FOR: **Amusement Park, Aquarium, Arcade, Circus, Park, Playground, Zoo**

BT: **Natural Environment**

³ Maze. (n.d.) In Merriam-Webster online. Retrieved from <http://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/maze>

Religious site

SN: A place of worship, usually for religions.

USE FOR: **Church**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Rural Area

SN: Geographic area that is located outside of the cities and towns.

USE FOR: **Rural, Village, Settlement**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Sky

SN: Everything that lies above the surface of earth, including the atmosphere, including outer space.

USE FOR: **Nature Reserve**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Space

USE: **Outer Space**

Surface

SN: Natural environment on Earth that has not been significantly modified by humans.

USE FOR: **Nature Reserve, Swamp, Tundra, Wilderness**

BT: **Natural Environment**

NT: **Beach, Caves, Forest, Island, Jungle, Plains, Volcano, Water**

Beach

SN: Landform along the coast of an ocean, sea, lake, or river that consists of loose particles like sand or rock.

BT: **Surface**

BT: **Natural Environment**

RT: **Island**

Caves

SN: Hollow place in the ground, especially a large underground space that humans can enter.

BT: **Surface**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Forest

SN: Area of land covered with trees or other woody vegetation.

BT: **Surface**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Island

SN: A body of land surrounded entirely by the ocean. It is often tropical in climate, but varying environments may exist closer to its center.

BT: **Surface**

BT: **Natural Environment**

RT: **Beach**

Jungle

SN: Area of land covered with dense vegetation.

BT: **Surface**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Lake

USE: **Water**

Ocean

USE: **Water**

Plains

SN: Flat region of land.

USE FOR: **Prairie**

BT: **Surface**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Praire

USE: **Plains**

River

USE: **Water**

Sea

USE: **Water**

Volcano

SN: A mountain with a crater or vent that allows contents from the earth's core (like lava) to surface

BT: **Surface**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Water

SN: Transparent fluid which forms the world's streams, lakes, oceans and rain, and is the major constituent of the fluids of living things.

USE FOR: **Lake, Ocean, River, Sea**

BT: **Surface**

BT: **Natural Environment**

RT: **Underwater**

Swamp

USE: **Surface**

Tundra

USE: **Surface**

Wilderness

USE: **Surface**

Underground

SN: An area located beneath the ground/surface level where the majority of human activity typically occurs. It is often characterized as an area where there is no sunlight.

RT: **Cave**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Underwater

SN: An area located beneath the water's surface level, in which marine and aquatic life thrive.

RT: **Water.**

BT: **Natural Environment**

Built Environment

SN: Material, spatial, and cultural product of human labor that combines physical elements and energy in forms for living, working and playing.

NT: **Arena, Castle, Cyberspace, Farm, Home, Hospital, Mine, Military Base, Prison, Ruins, School, Scientific Laboratory, Suburban, Urban, Vehicles**

Aircraft

USE: **Vehicles**

Amusement Park

USE: **Recreational site**

Apartment

USE: **Home**

Aquarium

USE: **Recreational site**

Arcade

USE: **Recreational site**

Arena

SN: An enclosed area, often circular or oval-shaped for sporting events or other purposes.

USE FOR: **Stadium, Coliseum**

BT: **Built Environment**

Asylum

USE: **Hospital**

Castle

SN: A monumentally large building, often constructed with stone, that houses and protects royalty (kings and queens).

BT: **Built Environment**

Church

USE: **Religious site**

Circus

USE: **Recreational site**

City

USE: **Urban**

Coliseum

USE: **Arena**

Cyberspace

SN: Environment in which communication over computer networks occurs.

BT: **Built Environment**

Farm

SN: Area of land that is devoted primarily to agricultural processes.

BT: **Built Environment**

Fortress

USE: **Military Base**

Jail

USE: **Prison**

Home

SN: Place used as a permanent or semi-permanent residence for an individual, family, household, etc.

USE FOR: **House, Apartment**

BT: **Built Environment**

Hospital

SN: An institution dedicated to administering healthcare services.

USE FOR: **Asylum**

BT: **Built Environment**

House

USE: **Home**

Mine

SN: A pit or tunnel from which minerals (such as coal, gold, diamonds, etc.) are taken.⁴

BT: **Built Environment**

Military Base

SN: Facility owned and operated by the military that shelters military equipment and personnel, and facilitates training and operations.

USE FOR: **Fortress**

BT: **Built Environment**

Prison

SN: Facility in which inmates are confined and denied a variety of freedoms under the authority of state as a form of punishment.

USE FOR: **Jail**

BT: **Built Environment**

⁴ Mine. (n.d.) In Merriam-Webster online. Retrieved from <http://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/mine>

Restaurant

SN: An establishment in which you may buy food that is cooked and prepared at that location. Patrons typically sit down and eat there, or get their food to go.

BT: **Built Environment**

Ruins

SN: Remains of human-made architecture: structures that were once complete, as time went by, have fallen into a state of partial or complete disrepair.

BT: **Built Environment**

School

SN: Institution designed to teach students led by teachers.

BT: **Built Environment**

Scientific Laboratory

SN: Facility that provides controlled conditions for scientific or technological research, experiments, measurements, etc.

USE FOR: **Labs, Laboratory**

BT: **Built Environment**

Settlement

USE: **Rural Area**

Ship

USE: **Vehicles**

Spaceship

USE: **Vehicles**

Stadium

USE: **Arena**

Submarine

USE FOR: **Vehicles**

Suburban

SN: Geographic area that exists as part of a city or urban area or as a separate residential community within commuting distance of a city.

BT: **Built Environment**

Subway

USE: **Vehicles**

Train

USE: **Vehicles**

Urban

SN: Geographic area that is characterized by a high population density and vast human-built features.

USE FOR: **Town, City**

BT: **Built Environment**

Vehicles

USE FOR: **Aircraft, Ship, Spaceship, Submarine, Subways, Train**

BT: **Built Environment**

Village

USE: **Rural Area**

Zoo

USE: **Recreational site**

Specific Location

SN: Used to denote specific locations in game. Provide Continent, state or province, city or town.

Unspecified

SN: Not stated clearly or exactly.